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LETTER TO EDITOR/LED REPLY

Ensuring Ethical and Responsible Integration of AI Tools in Healthcare

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We read with great interest the letter by Amnuay Kleebayoon and Viroj Wiwanitkit [1]. Thank you for facilitating this dialogue in light of our recent study, "Assessing the Accuracy of Responses by the Language Model ChatGPT to Questions Regarding Bariatric Surgery" [2]. We agree that considerations regarding the application and ethical use of AI tools such as ChatGPT are essential in order to safely and effectively utilize this technology in healthcare.

Our study evaluated the performance of ChatGPT in a particular context, specifically its ability to provide accurate and consistent responses to common patient inquiries related to bariatric surgery. It is important to clarify that our study does not advocate for ChatGPT or similar AI models to autonomously produce, evaluate, or accept primary content without human oversight. Rather, we consider AI as a tool to augment the capabilities of healthcare professionals, potentially enhancing patient education and engagement while always deferring to human expertise for critical decision-making.

Regarding ChatGPT's architecture, we feel that such technical discussions are beyond the scope of our study, which focused primarily on the current state of the model's accuracy in a specific context. However, we acknowledge that AI is a rapidly evolving field, and periodic updates to the underlying technology and architecture are inherent and necessary for its advancement.

We appreciate the authors call for an updated code of conduct when using ChatGPT in various contexts, including practice, teaching, and research. AI ethics, including issues such as fairness, accountability, transparency, and privacy, are indeed critical areas to be addressed. We strongly support initiatives that promote the responsible use of AI and the creation of comprehensive guidelines for its deployment in various sectors.

It is our hope that this research can further conversations about how to responsibly integrate AI technologies into healthcare and beyond, always prioritizing patient safety, data security, and the highest standard of care.

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Data Availability No data was analyzed or presented in this manuscript.

Declarations

Ethical Approval This article does not contain any studies with human participants or animals performed by any of the authors.

Informed Consent Informed consent does not apply.

Conflict of Interest The authors declare no competing interests.

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